

Improving access to imported food safety requirements

Imported food safety requirements are now included in the [Biosecurity Import Conditions system \(BICON\)](#).

See more about the [Inclusion of food safety requirements in BICON](#).

All biosecurity requirements must be met before [Imported Food Inspection Scheme](#) requirements apply.

Check our [Biosecurity Import Conditions system \(BICON\)](#) for biosecurity import conditions.

We classify imported food that presents a potential medium or high risk to public health as [risk food](#). All risk food is listed in the [Imported Food Control Order 2019](#).

Fresh beef and beef products are classified as risk food

This includes fresh raw (chilled or frozen) [beef](#) and [beef products](#):

- carcasses
- whole muscle meat and bone-in cuts
- ground (minced beef) and trim for grinding
- offal

You can only import fresh raw beef and beef products that originate in a country:

- with a satisfactory BSE risk [status](#)
- covered by a recognised foreign government certificate.

Beef offal is not permitted to be imported due to biosecurity restrictions. Refer to [BICON](#) to review the biosecurity import conditions.

Certification arrangements

Fresh raw (chilled or frozen) beef and beef products can only be imported from countries listed here.

Type of information To include

[National competent authority:](#)

Canadian Food Inspection Agency

Recognised certificate title:

Veterinary certificate for meat products and by products derived from cattle of all ages exported from Canada to Australia

ICS document code:

BSECERTCAN

Type of information

To include

[National competent authority:](#) Ministry of Agriculture, Forestry and Fisheries

Recognised certificate title: Export quarantine certificate for Beef from Japan to Australia

ICS document code: BSECERTJPR

Type of information To include

National competent authority: United States Department of Agriculture

Certificate for the Export of Fresh (Chilled or Frozen)

Recognised certificate title:

Bovine Meat and Bovine Meat Products to Australia

ICS document code:

BSECERTUSA

Declaring certificates

When lodging a [Full Import Declaration \(FID\)](#), you must declare your certificate in the Integrated Cargo System (ICS) by lodging the correct ICS document code and certificate number for the food.

See [lodging declarations and documentation](#).

Community Protection (CP) question

You will need to answer this CP question when lodging your [full import declaration](#):

IFIS: Are the goods raw minced/ground beef or raw beef intended for mincing/grinding (answer yes if the goods are raw beef patties or burgers)?

Testing and inspection

We refer consignments of fresh raw (chilled or frozen) beef and beef products for analytical testing at the rate of 5%. During inspection, we will also conduct a visual and label assessment.

Table 1 shows the tests that will be applied and permitted results for each food type.

Table 1, Food type, test applied and permitted results

Food type	Test applied	Permitted result
Fresh raw (chilled or frozen) beef	Escherichia coli	n=5, c=3, m=10, M=100 cfu/g
	Meat antimicrobial screen	Refer to meat and edible offal
Fresh raw (chilled or frozen) beef	Escherichia coli	n=5, c=3, m=100, M=1000 cfu/g
	Salmonella spp.	

	n=5, c=0, m=not detected in 25 g
Shiga toxin-producing E. coli (STEC)	
Includes STEC O26, O45, O103, O111, O121, O145, O157	n=15, c=0, m=not detected in 375 g
Meat antimicrobial screen	Refer to meat and edible offal

n = the number of samples to be analysed from a lot of food.

c = the maximum allowable number of defective sample units, that have counts between ‘m’ and ‘M’.

m = the acceptable microbiological level in a sample unit.

M = the level, which when exceeded (the level is greater than M), in one or more samples would cause the lot to be rejected.

Food safety risks

Food Standard Australia New Zealand has given us [advice that fresh raw beef and beef products](#) present a potential medium or high risk to public health for the pathogenic microorganisms Salmonella spp. and Shiga toxin-producing Escherichia coli (STEC). The risk increases for ground product. To make sure there are food safety controls in place to manage these hazards, imports must be:

- covered by a recognised [foreign government certificate](#)
- tested to verify these controls are effective.

Beef

Beef means the flesh, bone, offal or any other tissue of an animal in the subfamily bovinæ.

Beef products

Beef products means food prepared from or containing beef, but does not include gelatine, collagen, rendered fats, tallow or di-calcium phosphate.

Competent authority

The government authority or official body authorised by the government that is responsible for the setting of regulatory food safety requirements and/or for the organisation of official controls including enforcement.

Version history

Date	Amendment details
04/08/2025	Include USA and Canada certificate requirements, and minor amendments to clarify scope.

28/01/2022 First version of this webpage. Information previously contained in beef and beef products webpage (Reference number BEF 11/2018).

Source: <https://www.agriculture.gov.au/biosecurity-trade/import/goods/food/type/beef-fresh>